



RARE PEPES

036 / 09 SEP 2016 / COUNTERPARTY / UNCOMMON

THE MOST RARE PEPE

In September 2016, Rare Pepes brought internet meme culture into a market for blockchain-based art. Artists made their own versions of the familiar frog, while collectors could hold and trade the associated digital tokens. Counterparty recorded those assets through transactions on Bitcoin.

The first RAREPEPE issuance created 300 indivisible units on 9 September 2016, at 01:46:42 UTC in Bitcoin block 428,919. This is the event behind the card's date. The community's Book of Kek archive dates the first artwork's addition to the Rare Pepe Directory to 13 September, and identifies RAREPEPE as Series 1, Card 1.

The directory gave the expanding collection a catalogue: named assets, numbered cards and series. Each asset had its own issuance quantity. The 300 on this card belongs to the original RAREPEPE issue, rather than the entire Rare Pepe collection or its present circulating supply.

A picture could still be copied. Holding its token meant holding a recorded balance that could be transferred through Counterparty. The image and its token record did different jobs: one carried the joke and artwork; the other made a collectable edition traceable. Rare Pepes became an important early chapter in community-made cryptoart.

This scene turns that digital collecting culture into a fictional Moroccan souk. The merchant, collector, cards and market exchange are imagined. They make collecting tangible without claiming that Rare Pepes began in Morocco or that these are replicas of the original Nakamoto card.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE COUNTERPARTY RECEIPT

The paper marked COUNTERPARTY and the Bitcoin symbol link the imagined exchange to the protocol and blockchain used for the tokens. A paper receipt is a visual metaphor, not a historical transaction document.

02 DIRECTORY AND SERIES 1

The open binder makes the numbered catalogue visible. The Series 1 tab points to the collection's earliest group; the illustrated cards inside are invented designs.

03 THE FROG FOOTPRINT

A magnifying glass enlarges a green print, playing with the idea of checking a card's authenticity. It is an invented clue, not a real Rare Pepe authentication method or artefact.

04 RAREPEPE 300 ISSUED

The placard points to the 300 units originally issued for the first RAREPEPE asset. The number does not describe every Rare Pepe card or the collection's present supply.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: [original issuance record](#); [Counterparty asset documentation](#); [Book of Kek's project history](#) and [Series 1 archive](#). The phrase is an exact excerpt of the issuance description. The 13 September directory date is community-archive evidence; the original directory page could not be checked. Architecture was inspired by two user-supplied photographs with no supplied credit metadata. The souk is fictional staging. No cross-card cameo is identified.